

EFOS GLOBAL FINANCE HACKATHON 2026

Track 01 · Financial Planning & Analysis

Case 6 · Budget vs Actual Analysis

FMCG Budget vs Actual Performance Analysis & Dashboard

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FY 2025-26 (Apr-2025 to Mar-2026)

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a Budget vs Actual performance analysis for a fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) business across FY 2025-26 (April 2025 to March 2026), built from transaction-level data and consolidated into a monthly variance dashboard. The analysis compares actual revenue, expense and profit against budget on a month-by-month basis and identifies the departments driving overall spend.

For the full year, actual revenue came in marginally ahead of budget and actual expense came in marginally under budget, so actual profit exceeded the budgeted figure. The variance is small in aggregate, but it is not evenly spread across the year — a handful of months carried most of the favourable variance, while three months (May, Jul, Aug) missed their profit budget.

Full-Year KPI Summary (Rs. Lakh)

Metric	Actual	Budget	Variance
Revenue	1,278.31	1,275.00	+3.31 (+0.26%)
Expense	614.49	615.10	−0.61 (−0.10%)
Profit	663.82	659.90	+3.92 (+0.59%)
Profit Margin	51.9%	51.8%	+0.2 pp

2. Objective

Develop a dashboard comparing budgeted and actual performance for the FMCG business, identify the months and cost centres with the largest variances, and explain the financial drivers behind them — in line with Track 01, Case 6 of the EFOS Global Finance Hackathon 2026 brief.

3. Data & Methodology

- Source data: 205 transaction-level records (Raw_Data tab) covering revenue and expense postings by month and department, plus a separate Budget tab holding the FY25-26 monthly budget.
- Actuals were consolidated by month into Revenue, Expense and Profit (Actual = Revenue – Expense).
- Budget figures were consolidated on the same monthly basis for direct comparison.
- $\text{Variance} = \text{Actual} - \text{Budget}$; $\text{Variance \%} = \text{Variance} \div \text{Budget}$, calculated separately for revenue, expense and profit each month.
- Department-level figures (Section 5) reflect total transaction value posted against each department in Raw_Data — they combine revenue and expense postings and should be read as a spend/activity view, not a department profit view.

4. Dashboard Overview

The accompanying workbook (FMCG_FP&A_Dashboard.xlsx) contains a live dashboard with four headline KPIs (Total Revenue, Total Expense, Total Profit, Profit Margin), a monthly Budget-vs-Actual trend chart, a

department spend chart, and the full 12-month variance table with charts. All figures recalculate automatically from the Budget and Raw_Data input tabs.

5. Monthly Budget vs Actual Variance

Month	Actual Rev	Budget Rev	Actual Exp	Budget Exp	Actual Profit	Budget Profit	Profit Var %
Apr-2025	94.52	95.00	47.62	48.20	46.90	46.80	+0.21%
May-2025	104.33	105.00	51.60	51.00	52.73	54.00	-2.35%
Jun-2025	109.71	110.00	52.35	52.40	57.36	57.60	-0.42%
Jul-2025	97.25	98.00	47.76	47.08	49.49	50.92	-2.81%
Aug-2025	100.57	102.00	48.34	48.12	52.23	53.88	-3.06%
Sep-2025	109.46	108.00	50.09	49.68	59.37	58.32	+1.80%
Oct-2025	126.41	125.00	62.39	62.85	64.02	62.15	+3.01%
Nov-2025	136.39	135.00	66.29	66.15	70.10	68.85	+1.82%
Dec-2025	117.01	115.00	51.15	51.50	65.86	63.50	+3.72%
Jan-2026	89.48	90.00	45.17	45.00	44.31	45.00	-1.53%
Feb-2026	91.69	92.00	44.95	45.52	46.74	46.48	+0.56%
Mar-2026	101.49	100.00	46.78	47.60	54.71	52.40	+4.41%

Profit came in ahead of budget in 8 of the 12 months. December (+3.7%) and March (+4.4%) were the strongest months, both driven by revenue outperformance that more than offset small expense overruns. August (−3.1%) and July (−2.8%) were the weakest, in both cases because revenue fell short of budget while expense stayed close to plan — a demand-side shortfall rather than a cost-control issue.

6. Department-wise Spend Analysis

Department	Total Transaction Value (Rs. Lakh)	% of Total
Sales	1457.17	77.0%
Marketing	182.60	9.6%
Operations	159.43	8.4%
HR	56.40	3.0%
IT	37.20	2.0%

Sales accounts for the large majority of total transaction value (77%), consistent with an FMCG business where both revenue bookings and cost-of-sales flow through the sales function. Marketing (182.6L) and Operations (159.4L) are the next-largest cost centres and are the most actionable levers for expense management, since HR and IT together represent under 5% of total activity.

7. Key Findings

- Full-year performance is favourable but thin: revenue beat budget by only 0.26% and profit by 0.59% — the business is tracking to plan rather than materially outperforming it.

- Variance is concentrated, not uniform: Q3 (Oct–Dec) delivered the strongest profit outperformance, while the monsoon-season months (Jul–Aug) underperformed on revenue in both months.
- Expense discipline held up well across the year — expense variance stayed within $\pm 1.7\%$ of budget in every month, with no runaway cost months.
- The two weakest months (Jul, Aug) were driven by a revenue shortfall, not overspend, pointing to a seasonal demand pattern worth building into next year's budget rather than a cost-control gap.

8. Recommendations

- Re-baseline the Jul–Aug budget for next year using this year's actuals — the current budget appears to understate the seasonal dip, which is what produced two of the three negative-variance months.
- Investigate the Sep–Dec revenue outperformance (3 of 4 months beat budget) to identify whether it reflects a repeatable festive-season uplift that should be built into future budgets rather than treated as a one-off.
- Since Sales carries $\sim 77\%$ of total transaction value, prioritise it for a deeper monthly variance review; Marketing and Operations are the next most material levers for expense management.
- Maintain the current expense discipline (all months within $\pm 2\%$ of budget) as a benchmark for other cost centres.

9. Conclusion

The FMCG business closed FY 2025-26 marginally ahead of budget on revenue, expense and profit, with disciplined cost control throughout the year offsetting a seasonal revenue dip in July-August. The variance pattern is explainable and largely seasonal rather than structural, and the recommendations above are aimed at tightening next year's budget assumptions so that seasonal swings are anticipated rather than showing up as variances.